

Ticket #: ticket-001

Date: May 28, 2026

Reported by: End user (Remote employee)

Issue type: Network / VPN

Priority: High (User cannot work remotely)

User's description:

"I'm working from a coffee shop and can't connect to the corporate vpn. I need to access internal files."

Troubleshooting steps (in order performed):

Step 1: Verified physical connectivity

- User confirmed wifi is connected and can browse the internet (Google, news sites)
- Result: Internet works, the problem is specific to vpn

Step 2: Tested basic network connectivity

Asked the user to open the command prompt (cmd)

Ran: ping 8.8.8.8 → successful (4 replies, 0% loss)

Ran: ping companyvpn.example.com → failed (ping request could not find host)

Result: DNS resolution issue – computer cannot find vpn server address

Step 3: Checked DNS configuration

- ran: ipconfig /all
- found: DNS servers were set to the coffee shop's DHCP (192.168.1.1)
- result: coffee shop DNS is blocking or not resolving the corporate domain

Step 4: flushed DNS cache

- ran: ipconfig /flushdns
- retried ping companyvpn.example.com → still failed
- result: DNS cache was not the issue

Step 5: Changed DNS servers temporarily

- Went to: control panel → network and sharing → change adapter settings
- Right-click wifi → properties → internet protocol version 4 (tcp/ipv4)
- Changed from "obtain DNS automatically" to "use the following DNS"
- Set primary: 8.8.8.8 (google DNS)
- Set secondary: 1.1.1.1 (cloudflare DNS)

Step 6: tested again

- Ran: ping companyvpn.example.com → successful
- User launched vpn client → connected successfully
- User confirmed access to internal files

Root cause:

The coffee shop's DNS server was blocking or failing to resolve the corporate vpn gateway domain name. This is common on public WIFI networks that use DNS filtering or have stale cache.

Resolution:

Set the user's wireless adapter to use Google DNS (8.8.8.8) and Cloudflare DNS (1.1.1.1) as a temporary workaround.

Prevention / long-term fix:

1. Configure the corporate VPN client to use the IP address as a fallback when DNS fails
2. Deploy DNS over HTTPS (DoH) via group policy for remote laptops
3. Document steps to change DNS for the help desk team

Follow-up actions:

- Monitor the user's VPN stability for 3 days
- Work with the network team to ensure vpn gateway has proper public DNS records
- Consider adding a secondary VPN gateway IP in the client config

Ticket status: resolved

Time to resolve: 35 minutes